

Post-Cold War Tanks (cont.)

Conflicts since 1989 have shown that tanks still have a role on the battlefield. Although heavy and difficult to deploy, when needed they offer unmatched protection and all-weather, long-range surveillance, along with accurate firepower. Tanks have been used for peacekeeping operations in the Balkans and Lebanon, as well as for counterinsurgency in Iraq and Afghanistan, and conventional fighting in Syria, Yemen, and Ukraine. During the 21st century, a number of new vehicles have begun to enter service, some with countries that are new to tank design.



△	Type 99
Date	2001
Country	China
Weight	55.1 tons (50 tonnes)
Engine	WD396 V8 diesel, 1,200 hp
Main armament	125 mm ZPT-98 smoothbore gun

Along with the Type 96, the Type 99 forms the backbone of the Chinese Army's tank fleet. Protected by advanced ERA and a laser warning system, it uses more modern thermal sights, gun stabilization, and has hunter-killer capability. The Type 99A and Type 99A2 have recieved further upgrades.



△	Leopard 2A6
Date	2001
Country	Germany
Weight	68.8 tons (62.4 tonnes)
Engine	MTU MB 873 Ka-501 diesel, 1,500 hp
Main armament	120 mm Rheinmetall 120 L/55 smoothbore gun

A significant upgrade to the 2A4 from the Cold War era, the 2A6 incorporates distinctive wedge-shaped spaced armor on the turret and the more powerful L/55 gun. The gunner's sight has moved to the turret roof, and the turret is now electrically powered rather than being hydraulically driven.

▷	Al-Khalid
Date	2001
Country	Pakistan/China
Weight	52.9 tons (48 tonnes)
Engine	KMDB 6TD-2 multifuel, 1,200 hp
Main armament	125 mm smoothbore gun

A collaboration between Pakistan and China, the Al-Khalid, or the MBT-2000, was the most advanced part of a Pakistani project to upgrade its tank fleet. It has a three-man crew, ERA, and a laser-warning system. As of 2016, upgrades to this tank are under development.

